



India & Tunisia: Building Bridges, Expanding Opportunities, Shaping a Shared Future

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FOREWORD

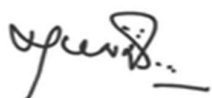
India and Tunisia share a relationship built on longstanding diplomatic goodwill, cultural understanding, and a growing foundation for economic cooperation. Yet, the depth of this relationship is not fully reflected in the scale and diversity of bilateral trade and investment. This Strategic Cooperation Report has been prepared with the objective of identifying practical opportunities through which this potential can be converted into measurable outcomes. Tunisia's strategic location at the intersection of Europe, Africa and the Arab world, combined with its strengths in fertilizers and chemicals, olive oil, dates, manufacturing, tourism, pharmaceuticals, renewable energy and digital services, offers important opportunities for Indian businesses.

At **CCI India**, we believe that chambers of commerce have an important role to play in converting opportunities into partnerships. Our contribution should be practical and industry-driven: connecting businesses, facilitating buyer-seller engagements, supporting investment matchmaking, providing market intelligence, enabling sectoral dialogue, assisting market access, and creating platforms through which Indian and Tunisian enterprises can identify credible partners and develop commercial relationships. The proposed cooperation framework therefore positions CCI India as a trade facilitator, business connector, investment facilitator, knowledge platform, policy bridge and ecosystem builder, while respecting the distinct responsibilities of governments, embassies and statutory institutions.

The report also proposes a structured approach through sectoral programmes, market-access initiatives, knowledge and research activities, capacity building, investment facilitation and a proposed India–Tunisia Business Council. These mechanisms are intended to create continuity in engagement rather than limiting cooperation to individual meetings or isolated business delegations.

Our vision is clear: **to build an India–Tunisia economic partnership that is broader, more diversified, commercially meaningful and sustainable**. This requires moving beyond conventional trade promotion toward long-term business relationships, investment partnerships, technology cooperation, knowledge exchange and stronger institutional connectivity.

I am confident that this report will serve as a useful reference for policymakers, diplomats, investors, industry leaders, exporters, importers and other stakeholders seeking to deepen India–Tunisia economic relations. CCI India looks forward to working closely with the **Embassy of Tunisia in New Delhi, Tunisian institutions, Indian industry, investors and relevant stakeholders** to advance this shared agenda and strengthen the economic bridge between India and Tunisia.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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TUNISIA

“Explore Mediterranean charm blended with rich history and modern tourism



Introduction

The Republic of Tunisia is a North African nation located at the crossroads of the Mediterranean Sea, Africa, and Europe. Known for its ancient Carthaginian heritage, strategic maritime position, and a highly literate population, Tunisia plays an important role in the Maghreb region.

Its economy is relatively diversified compared to many regional peers, with key strengths in manufacturing, tourism, agriculture, phosphates, and ICT services. India and Tunisia share warm and cooperative relations, supported by political goodwill, economic partnerships, and development cooperation initiatives. The Embassy of Tunisia in New Delhi plays a central role in facilitating diplomatic coordination, trade partnerships, and people-to-people exchanges between the two countries.

Basic Facts & Demographics

Tunisia is a republic with its capital in Tunis. The country has a population of approximately 12.4–12.6 million (2024–2025 estimates) and covers an area of around 163,610 sq. km. The official language is Arabic, with French widely used in administration, business, and education. The national currency is the Tunisian Dinar.

Tunisia's demographic profile includes high literacy rates (over 80%), a strong university system, and a skilled workforce that supports its manufacturing and service industries. Its strategic location along the Mediterranean Sea positions it as a key link between Africa, Europe, and the Middle East, enhancing its trade and investment potential.

Economy

Tunisia is a republic with its capital in Tunis. It has a population of about 12.4–12.6 million and an area of around 163,610 sq. km. The official language is Arabic, with French widely used, and the currency is the Tunisian Dinar. Tunisia has high literacy rates, a strong education system, and a skilled workforce. Its location along the Mediterranean Sea makes it an important link between Africa, Europe, and the Middle East, boosting its trade potential.



“ Culture and Heritage

The culture and heritage of Tunisia are shaped by a rich history of civilizations including Phoenician, Roman, Arab, and Ottoman influences. This diverse past is reflected in its architecture, traditions, and cuisine, blending Mediterranean and Arab elements. Traditional crafts such as pottery, weaving, and mosaics showcase Tunisia's artistic heritage, while music and festivals play an important role in cultural life. Historic sites like Carthage highlight its ancient legacy, while Islam continues to influence social customs and everyday practices, making Tunisia's culture both diverse and deeply rooted in history.

Trade with India (Bilateral Trade – in Billions)

India and Tunisia maintain stable and complementary trade relations, with bilateral trade typically ranging between USD 521.71 million annually, depending on global commodity prices and domestic demand in both countries. Tunisia is a key supplier of phosphatic fertilizers to India—particularly DAP and phosphoric acid—making fertilizers a cornerstone of the bilateral trade basket.

Import & Export from India

Tunisia's exports include mechanical and electrical components, automotive wiring systems, textiles and apparel, olive oil, dates, phosphates and fertilizer products, and certain chemicals. Its imports mainly consist of machinery, mineral fuels and petroleum products, cereals (including wheat and rice), electrical equipment, pharmaceuticals, and consumer goods.

Tunisia's geographic position enables strong trade links with Europe, while markets in Africa and Asia—including India—are becoming increasingly important as it diversifies its trade partnerships. Its participation in regional agreements, such as the Arab Maghreb Union and the African Continental Free Trade Area, also shapes its evolving trade trajectory.



Cultural & People-To-People Links

Cultural contacts between India and Tunisia include exchanges through scholarship programmes, academic collaborations, tourism, film festivals, and participation in India's training initiatives under Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme. Indian culture—such as Bollywood, yoga, Ayurveda, and cuisine—has a visible presence in Tunisia, while Tunisian art, music, and Mediterranean heritage attract Indian travellers and researchers. These interactions help build goodwill and create a strong foundation for deeper economic cooperation between the two countries.

Opportunities & Risks for Indian Businesses in Tunisia

Opportunities:

- Exporting pharmaceuticals, where India is a major global supplier
- Supplying automotive and engineering goods to Tunisia's manufacturing clusters
- Increasing foodgrain exports (especially rice) to meet domestic demand
- Participating in renewable energy projects, particularly solar and wind
- Expanding IT and business services collaboration with Tunisia's skilled workforce
- Forming joint ventures in textiles, electronics, and component manufacturing

Risks:

- Fiscal pressures and external financing needs affecting government procurement
- Exchange-rate volatility of the Tunisian Dinar impacting contract values
- Regulatory complexities and slower administrative approvals for foreign investors
- Fluctuations in global fertilizer prices influencing trade dynamics

Indian businesses can mitigate risks by engaging with the Tunisian Embassy in New Delhi for updated market insights, due diligence, and industry connections.

CHAPTER 1 TUNISIA: COUNTRY OVERVIEW

Geography and Strategic Location

Tunisia sits at the northernmost point of the African continent, bordered by Algeria to the west, Libya to the southeast, and roughly 1,300 kilometres of Mediterranean coastline to the north and east. The country lies barely 140 kilometres from Sicily across the Strait of Sicily, placing it closer to continental Europe than any other North African state. This geography has historically made Tunisia a hinge between Europe, the Arab Maghreb, and Sub-Saharan Africa a positioning increasingly formalised through overlapping trade architecture: an Association Agreement and free trade area with the European Union, membership of the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA), the Arab Maghreb Union, the Greater Arab Free Trade Area, and observer status with the Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS).

Population and Demographics

Tunisia's population stood at approximately 12.39 million in 2025. The country has one of the highest literacy rates in North Africa and a long tradition of technical and engineering education, producing a workforce that has historically underpinned its role as a nearshoring manufacturing base for European automotive, aerospace, textile and electronics firms. Major population centres include the capital Tunis, along with Sfax, Sousse, Kairouan and Bizerte each anchoring distinct industrial and agricultural hinterlands.

Political and Administrative Structure

Tunisia is a unitary republic, divided into 24 governorates. Since constitutional changes adopted in 2022, the country operates under a presidential system with a reconfigured legislature. The currency is the Tunisian dinar (TND), which is not freely convertible and remains subject to capital controls administered by the Central Bank of Tunisia a structural feature that Indian investors and traders must factor into commercial planning, repatriation of profits, and invoicing currency choice.

Infrastructure and Connectivity

Tunisia's port infrastructure includes the deep-water port of Radès (the country's principal container gateway near Tunis), the port of Sfax, and the export-oriented port of Skhira, which handles bulk chemical and hydrocarbon cargo including phosphoric acid shipments to India under the TIFERT arrangement. The World Bank's 2025 connectivity assessment for Tunisia found that improving port connectivity and reducing dwell times could raise GDP by 4–5% within three to four years, underscoring both an existing logistics constraint and an area where Indian port-technology, logistics and customs-modernisation expertise could find commercial application. Tunisia's principal international gateway is Tunis-Carthage International Airport, complemented by airports at Monastir, Djerba, Sfax and Tozeur serving the tourism sector.

Human Capital, Education and Digital Infrastructure

Tunisia maintains a network of public universities and engineering schools with a historical orientation toward France and, increasingly, diversified international partnerships. Digital infrastructure has expanded steadily, and the government has articulated priorities around digital public infrastructure and e-governance an area of demonstrated Indian comparative advantage (India Stack, UPI-linked payment rails, Aadhaar-style identity systems) that recurs as a theme in bilateral discussions on technology cooperation.

Why Tunisia Matters Strategically to Indian Companies and Investors

- Gateway positioning: preferential access to EU markets under the Association Agreement, and to African markets under AfCFTA, from a single manufacturing or processing base.
- Proven industrial partnership: the TIFERT joint venture demonstrates that large-scale Indian capital can be deployed successfully in Tunisia over a multi-decade horizon.
- High-value agri-food specialisation: global leadership in olive oil and premium dates offers India both a sourcing opportunity and a market-development opportunity for its own outbound trade and retail sector.
- Underpenetrated bilateral trade relative to potential: at approximately US\$521.71 million in 2024–25, bilateral trade remains a fraction of the USD 1 billion target set by the two governments in 2017, indicating significant unrealised headroom.
- A skilled, francophone-and-Arabic-speaking, English-conversant professional class well suited to shared services, IT-enabled services, and technical collaboration.

CHAPTER 2 TUNISIAN ECONOMY

Tunisia's economy is a lower-middle-income, diversified economy in which services account for the largest share of output, followed by industry and agriculture. The following indicators, drawn from the World Bank and the African Development Bank's 2026 Tunisia Economic Outlook, describe the current macroeconomic position and are each followed by a brief note on their implication for Indian business planning.

Indicator	Latest Verified Value	Year	Source
GDP growth (real)	2.5%	2025	AfDB Tunisia Economic Outlook, 2026
GDP growth forecast	2.1% (2026f), 2.8% (2027f)	2026–27	AfDB Tunisia Economic Outlook, 2026
Population	~12.39 million	2025	World Bank / national data
Inflation (average)	5.7% (down from 7.0%)	2025	AfDB Tunisia Economic Outlook, 2026
Central Bank policy rate	7% (cut from 8%)	Dec. 2025	World Bank Group Tunisia overview
Unemployment (Q4)	15.2% (down from 16.5% Q4 2024)	Q4 2025	World Bank Group Tunisia overview

Youth unemployment (15–24)	38.4%	2025	AfDB Tunisia Economic Outlook, 2026
Net FDI inflows	1.6% of GDP (est.)	2025	World Bank Group Tunisia overview
Current account deficit	2.4% of GDP	2025	World Bank MPO Tunisia note
Fiscal deficit	projected 6.1% of GDP	2026	World Bank MPO Tunisia note
Merchandise exports	US\$23.3 billion	2024	Wikipedia/Economy of Tunisia, national trade data
Merchandise imports	US\$26.4 billion	2024	Wikipedia/Economy of Tunisia, national trade data

What This Means for Indian Businesses

- Moderate but positive growth (2.1–2.8% over 2026–27) signals a stabilising, not booming, domestic market Indian exporters should prioritise sectors with structural demand (agri-inputs, pharmaceuticals, capital goods for export-oriented manufacturing) over discretionary consumer categories in the near term.
- A managed exchange rate and capital controls on the Tunisian dinar mean Indian exporters and investors should structure contracts in hard currency (USD/EUR) and plan for profit-repatriation lead times.
- Declining but still-present inflation and a gradually easing policy rate suggest improving, though still tight, domestic financing conditions joint ventures requiring local debt financing should budget for continued relatively high borrowing costs.
- High youth unemployment (38.4%) is simultaneously a social challenge and a labour-supply opportunity: Indian firms establishing export-oriented manufacturing or IT-enabled services operations in Tunisia can draw on an available, educated, underemployed youth cohort.
- A structurally negative trade balance (exports of US\$23.3bn against imports of US\$26.4bn in 2024) means Tunisia has a clear incentive to diversify export destinations and grow value-added exports creating an opening for India to position itself as a growth market for Tunisian olive oil, dates and processed agri-food products.

Sectoral Structure

Services account for the largest share of Tunisian GDP, followed by industry (manufacturing, mining and construction) and agriculture. Within industry, textiles and apparel, automotive components, mechanical and electrical goods, and chemicals/phosphates form the core export-oriented base; within agriculture, olive oil and dates are the flagship high-value export categories.

CHAPTER 3 MAJOR SECTORS OF TUNISIA

This chapter surveys Tunisia's principal economic sectors using a consistent analytical framework, before Chapters 4 through 8 develop the five sectors of greatest near-term relevance to India olive oil, dates, fertilizers and chemicals, tourism, and film and entertainment in significantly greater depth.

Agriculture & Agribusiness

Agriculture contributes a modest but strategically important share of Tunisian GDP and remains the country's most globally competitive export cluster in value-added terms, anchored by olive oil and dates. Beyond these two flagship products, Tunisia produces citrus, cereals, and a range of horticultural products, though it remains a net cereal importer, exposing the economy to global grain price volatility.

India relevance: India's food-processing, cold-chain and agri-input companies (seeds, fertilizers, irrigation technology) have a demonstrable interface with Tunisian agribusiness, particularly around water-efficient irrigation given the country's structural water scarcity.

Automotive & Auto Components

Tunisia has built a sizeable automotive-component manufacturing base wiring harnesses, electrical components and mechanical parts serving European original equipment manufacturers under EU-linked trade preferences.

Opportunity for India: Indian auto-component manufacturers could explore contract manufacturing or joint ventures using Tunisia as an EU-facing export platform, leveraging Tunisia's preferential EU market access, which Indian-based production does not enjoy directly.

Textiles & Apparel

Textiles and garments remain a significant, EU-oriented Tunisian export category, though the sector faces competitive pressure from lower-cost Asian producers.

Opportunity: potential for Indian textile-machinery and technical-textile suppliers, and for Indian apparel brands to examine EU-preferential sourcing arrangements via Tunisian manufacturing partners.

Pharmaceuticals & Healthcare

Tunisia has a growing generic pharmaceutical manufacturing sector serving domestic and regional (African) markets. India, as the world's largest generic-drug producer, has an evident complementary opportunity in technology transfer, contract manufacturing partnerships, and API supply an area meriting a dedicated CCI India scoping mission given the depth of India's pharmaceutical export capability into Africa via Tunisia's regional and AfCFTA market access.

Renewable Energy

Tunisia has articulated an energy-transition strategy targeting a substantially higher share of renewables in its electricity mix, driven by strong solar-irradiation potential and government-backed solar and wind procurement programmes, alongside interest in green hydrogen for export to Europe.

Opportunity for India: Indian renewable-energy EPC contractors, solar-module manufacturers and green-hydrogen technology developers are well placed to participate in Tunisia's energy transition, an area explicitly referenced in bilateral cooperation discussions on renewable energy and water management.

ICT & Digital Technology

Tunisia has a maturing ICT-enabled services sector, historically oriented toward francophone Europe. Opportunity: India's globally leading digital-public-infrastructure model (identity, payments, data exchange) is a recurring theme in India-Tunisia cooperation discussions on trade, technology and training, and could be extended through structured government-to-government and CCI-facilitated technical-assistance programmes.

Manufacturing (General)

Beyond automotive and textiles, Tunisia hosts a diversified light-manufacturing base (electronics assembly, mechanical goods) benefiting from EU proximity and a relatively skilled, cost-competitive labour force, illustrated by recent European electronics-manufacturing investment in Tunisia.

Tourism, Film & Entertainment, and Restaurants & Hospitality

These three interconnected sectors are treated in depth further, given their significance to India-Tunisia people-to-people ties, and given the explicit instruction to develop dedicated CCI India programmes for tourism promotion and film cooperation.

Sector Analysis Framework Applied Throughout This Report

For each priority sector covered in the chapters that follow, this report applies a consistent eight-part framework: Tunisia's Strength; Tunisia's Challenge; India Opportunity; Tunisia Opportunity in India; Market Barrier; CCI India Role; Proposed Initiative; and Expected Outcome. This structure is designed to move from description to actionable recommendation in every sector discussed.

CHAPTER 4 OLIVE OIL SECTOR

Production, Trade Position and Recent Performance

Tunisia is the world's second-largest olive oil exporter by volume after the European Union bloc-adjusted rankings place it among the top three individual-country exporters, capturing 27.9% of global olive oil exports in the 2024–25 season with 226,472 tonnes, according to the International Olive Council.

Olive cultivation covers roughly one-third of Tunisia's total arable land, and the sector supports more than 309,000 producers, making it one of the country's most socially significant export industries. The 2025/26 harvest is on track to be a record year: the Tunisian Ministry of Agriculture and industry sources estimate production in the range of 400,000–450,000 tonnes, with the National Olive Oil Office (ONH) forecasting exports of approximately 300,000 tonnes for the season around 50% higher than the prior campaign.

Structurally, the sector remains heavily weighted toward bulk exports: bulk shipments represent 85–87% of export volume, with bottled/package oil accounting for only 13–15%, though bottled extra-virgin exports have been growing (up 30% in one recent reporting period to roughly 2,500 tonnes). Extra-virgin oil accounts for roughly 78–83% of exported volume depending on the campaign.

Three markets Italy (~27%), Spain (~25%) and the United States (~20%) absorb over 70% of Tunisian olive oil exports, with the EU as a bloc taking approximately 57%. This concentration in bulk, EU/US-destined trade is precisely the structural vulnerability that creates India's opportunity: a bottled, branded, India-facing olive oil trade would both diversify Tunisia's markets and capture higher margins for Tunisian exporters than the discounted bulk trade that has depressed producer revenue even in high-volume years (2024/25 saw a 40% rise in export volume alongside a roughly 29% fall in earnings, reflecting a period of price weakness and reported irregularities in bulk sales channels).

Tunisia's Strength

Global top-three olive oil exporter with a proven extra-virgin quality profile (Tunisian oils have won numerous international awards, including roughly ten medals at the 2025 New York International Olive Oil Competition), deep exportable supply (250,000–500,000 tonnes in strong years), and an established national strategy including a 2026 national promotional programme explicitly aimed at expanding into new markets in Asia and Latin America, referenced publicly by the Tunisian presidency.

Tunisia's Challenge

Overwhelming reliance on bulk, low-margin exports to a narrow set of Western markets; price volatility from harvest-to-harvest alternation (bearing/off-bearing cycles typical of olive cultivation); reported irregularities in below-official-price bulk sales; and limited brand visibility for Tunisian olive oil relative to Spanish and Italian competitors in most non-European markets, including India.

India Opportunity

India's olive oil consumption, while still small relative to traditional edible oils, has been rising steadily on the back of health and wellness trends, urban retail expansion, and growth in the hotel, restaurant and institutional catering (HORECA) segment. India currently imports the substantial majority of its consumed olive oil, with Spain and Italy as the dominant supplying origins; Tunisia's presence in the Indian market remains marginal despite its status as a top global exporter and despite existing, if minor, Indian imports of Tunisian olive-residue and olive oil products already captured in bilateral trade data.

Tunisia Opportunity in India

- Premium, bottled extra-virgin olive oil positioned in modern retail, e-commerce and gourmet/specialty grocery channels.
- Bulk supply contracts to Indian edible-oil refiners and packagers seeking to build private-label olive oil ranges.
- Institutional and HORECA supply to five-star hotels, premium restaurant chains and the wellness/spa industry.
- Cosmetics and personal-care applications, given olive oil's established use in skincare and haircare formulations.

Market Barrier

India applies tariffs on imported edible oils that affect landed cost competitiveness; distribution in India is fragmented across importers, distributors and modern trade, requiring on-the-ground market development rather than passive export; and Tunisian exporters, oriented historically toward EU/US buyers, generally lack established Indian importer relationships, retail packaging adapted for the Indian market, or brand recognition among Indian consumers.

CCI India Role and Proposed Initiative

CCI India can convene the market intelligence, importer connections, and promotional platform that neither individual Tunisian exporters nor the Indian import trade currently provide at scale. The following programme is proposed.

CCI INDIA OLIVE OIL MARKET DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME

- Phase 1 Market research: commission or compile a detailed Indian olive-oil demand study covering import volumes, tariff structure, retail price bands, and consumer segments, in partnership with Indian edible-oil industry associations.
- Phase 2 Importer and distributor identification: build a database of Indian olive-oil importers, dry-goods distributors, modern-trade retail buyers and e-commerce category managers willing to evaluate Tunisian supply.
- Phase 3 Buyer-seller meetings: organise structured B2B meetings between Tunisian exporters/exporter associations and shortlisted Indian buyers, potentially timed around existing Indian food and agri trade fairs.
- Phase 4 Government and policy engagement: facilitate structured dialogue with India's Department of Commerce and Ministry of Commerce and Industry on tariff treatment and market-access conditions for Tunisian olive oil, working alongside the Embassy of Tunisia.
- Phase 5 Culinary and hospitality promotion: partner with Indian hotel groups, culinary institutes and premium restaurant chains on Tunisian olive-oil tasting and menu-integration programmes.
- Phase 6 Retail and consumer awareness: support Tunisian exporters in developing India-adapted branding and packaging, and explore e-commerce and modern-trade listing support.

- Phase 7 Long-term market development: establish a standing India–Tunisia Olive Oil Working Group (see Chapter 14, Pillar 4) to sustain the relationship beyond initial promotional activity, and to explore upstream olive-cultivation cooperation and investment opportunities.

Expected Outcome

A measurable increase in Tunisia's share of India's olive oil import basket over a three-year horizon, a functioning pipeline of Indian importer relationships for Tunisian exporters, and the establishment of at least one recognised Tunisian olive oil brand in premium Indian retail and HORECA channels.

CHAPTER 5 DATES & AGRI-FOOD TRADE

Production and Export Position

Tunisia is a leading global exporter of dates by value, driven overwhelmingly by the premium Deglet Nour variety often called the 'queen of dates' grown in the oasis regions of Kebili and Tozeur in southern Tunisia. While Tunisia accounts for only around 2% of global date production by volume, it captures roughly 21% of global date export value and around 55% of EU date import value, reflecting the premium positioning of Deglet Nour relative to bulk date varieties from other origins. The 2025/26 harvest was the largest in the country's history, reaching approximately 404,000 tonnes, of which around 347,000 tonnes were Deglet Nour, following a rebound from a drought-affected 2024/25 season. Existing Tunisian date exports are heavily weighted toward European destinations France, Italy, Spain, Germany and the United Kingdom with a smaller but present footprint in Indian bilateral trade data already visible in current COMTRADE figures for edible fruit and nut exports to India (see Chapter 10).

Tunisia's Strength

A globally recognised premium date variety with strong brand equity among gourmet and gifting buyers; established processing capability including date paste, date syrup and date-based ingredients suited to food-manufacturing applications; and Protected Geographical Indication status for Deglet Nour dates from Kébili and Tozeur, established in 2012, which supports premium positioning.

Tunisia's Challenge

Water-intensive cultivation (the Deglet Nour variety requires an estimated 20,000 cubic metres of water per hectare) in a water-scarce country, raising sustainability questions that Indian buyers and investors should factor into long-term sourcing strategy; a fragmented exporter base following liberalisation of the sector, which some importers report has pressured prices; and continued reliance on a narrow set of European buyers.

India Opportunity

India is one of the world's largest dry-fruit and dates consuming markets, with demand concentrated around festive and gifting occasions most prominently Diwali as well as steady year-round demand in health-food, snacking and corporate-gifting segments. India's existing dates imports are dominated by other Gulf and North African origins; premium Tunisian Deglet Nour has a clear positioning opportunity in India's growing premium dry-fruit and gourmet gifting segment, distinct from the mass-market date trade.

Tunisia Opportunity in India

- Premium branded Deglet Nour dates for corporate and festive gifting, particularly around Diwali.
- Date-based food-processing ingredients (paste, syrup, powder) for India's growing natural-sweetener and health-food manufacturing sector.
- Organic-certified date lines, given rising Tunisian organic date production (reported at around 5,000 tonnes per year) matching rising Indian demand for certified organic gourmet foods.
- E-commerce-led direct-to-consumer positioning through India's expanding premium grocery and gourmet-food platforms.

CCI INDIA–TUNISIA DATES MARKET ACCESS PROGRAMME

- Identify and profile leading Indian dry-fruit importers and distributors with existing cold-chain and retail-distribution capability.
- Convene buyer-seller meetings between Tunisian date exporters/cooperatives and Indian importers, timed to precede the Diwali gifting season for maximum commercial relevance.
- Support product positioning for premium, PGI-certified Deglet Nour distinct from mass-market date offerings already present in the Indian market.
- Facilitate connections with Indian corporate-gifting platforms and e-commerce gourmet-food channels.
- Engage Indian food processors on date-paste and date-syrup ingredient sourcing for the natural-sweetener segment.

Expected Outcome

A structured, repeatable seasonal trade pipeline linking Tunisian date exporters to India's festive and corporate-gifting demand cycle, and diversification of Tunisia's date export markets beyond its current European concentration. Such a pipeline would align Tunisia's Deglet Nour and other premium date varieties with India's peak demand windows around Diwali, Eid, and year-end corporate gifting, where high-quality dates are increasingly favoured as premium, health-conscious gift items. Beyond the immediate trade gains, this partnership would help Tunisian exporters de-risk their revenue base while offering Indian importers reliable access to a differentiated, high-quality product source outside the traditional Gulf-dominated supply chain.

CHAPTER 6 FERTILIZERS & CHEMICALS

Tunisia's Phosphate Endowment and Chemical Industry

Tunisia holds the world's third-largest phosphate rock reserves and has built, since the establishment of North Africa's first fertilizer plant in 1952, a substantial chemical-processing industry around this resource, anchored by the state entities Compagnie des Phosphates de Gafsa (CPG), which mines phosphate rock, and Groupe Chimique Tunisien (GCT), which processes it into phosphoric acid and downstream fertilizer products. This phosphate-chemicals complex is Tunisia's most consequential point of direct industrial partnership with India.

Case Study: TIFERT (Tunisian-Indian Fertilizers)

Tunisian Indian Fertilizers S.A. (TIFERT) is a joint-venture phosphoric acid plant located at Skhira on Tunisia's south-eastern coast, established through a partnership between Tunisia's CPG and GCT (holding a combined 70% stake) and India's Coromandel International Limited and Gujarat State Fertilizers and Chemicals Limited (GSFC) (holding a combined stake reported at around 15% for GSFC, with Coromandel holding a comparable strategic stake). Built at a reported investment of approximately US\$450 million, the plant was inaugurated in July 2013 by Tunisia's then-Minister of Industry and India's Minister of State for Chemicals & Fertilizers, and has a production capacity of approximately 360,000 tonnes of phosphoric acid per year, with the Indian partners' offtake shipped to India including to Coromandel's Kakinada, Andhra Pradesh facility for further processing into diammonium phosphate (DAP) and other finished fertilizers under long-term supply agreements. India today accounts for close to 50% of Tunisia's total global phosphoric acid exports, a concentration that reflects the durability of this industrial relationship over more than a decade. Phosphate production volumes have fluctuated over the past decade due to periods of political and labour instability at mining sites since 2011, a factor Indian offtakers and prospective new investors should weigh in supply-security planning; production saw a notable uptick in more recent years.

Tunisia's Strength

- World-class phosphate reserves and an established, India-linked processing and export infrastructure at Skhira.
- A demonstrated, multi-decade track record of successful large-scale Indian industrial investment (TIFERT) that de-risks future Indian capital deployment in the sector.
- Proximity to European and Mediterranean chemical-industry supply chains, offering Indian chemical companies a platform for onward regional distribution.

Tunisia's Challenge

- Periodic disruption to phosphate mining output linked to social and labour unrest in mining regions since 2011, affecting feedstock reliability.
- Capital intensity and financing constraints limiting expansion of downstream chemical-processing capacity.

India Opportunity

India's fertilizer demand is structurally large and growing, underpinned by the scale of Indian agriculture and continued government subsidy support for phosphatic fertilizers. Diversifying phosphoric-acid and rock-phosphate sourcing away from concentration in any single origin is a stated strategic priority for Indian fertilizer companies and policymakers, given India's near-total reliance on imported phosphate rock and phosphoric acid. Tunisia, alongside Morocco, Jordan, Senegal and other origins, forms part of this diversification strategy, and the TIFERT relationship provides a proven template for expansion.

CCI INDIA FERTILIZER & CHEMICALS COOPERATION PROGRAMME

- Convene an India–Tunisia Fertilizer & Chemicals Partnership Forum bringing together Indian fertilizer majors (including but not limited to the existing TIFERT partners), Tunisia's CPG and GCT, and relevant financing institutions to explore capacity expansion, feedstock diversification, and potential new joint ventures beyond the existing TIFERT plant.
- Facilitate technology-transfer discussions in downstream specialty chemicals and value-added fertilizer products, an area where Indian chemical-engineering capability could support Tunisian industrial upgrading.
- Support long-term offtake and supply-security dialogue between Indian fertilizer companies and Tunisian phosphate producers, particularly given India's stated interest in diversified, long-term-contracted phosphate sourcing.
- Explore joint-venture investment opportunities in adjacent chemical value chains (sulphuric acid, specialty fertilizers, industrial chemicals) building on the trust established through TIFERT's operating history.

Expected Outcome

An expanded and more resilient India-Tunisia phosphate and fertilizer supply relationship, potentially including new joint-venture capacity beyond TIFERT, and a structured forum through which both governments' stated interest in fertilizer-sector cooperation can be translated into specific investment proposals.

CHAPTER 7 TOURISM & HOSPITALITY

Sector Overview and Recent Performance

Tunisia's tourism sector achieved a historic milestone in 2025, surpassing 11 million visitors for the first time in the country's history well above the pre-pandemic record of approximately 9.4 million set in 2019 and generating record tourism revenue of approximately 8.1 billion Tunisian dinars (roughly US\$2.68 billion), a 6.3% increase over 2024, according to Central Bank of Tunisia data. Tourism contributed an estimated 9% of GDP in 2024 and supported approximately 400,000 jobs.

Growth has been driven by a deliberate strategy to extend the tourism season beyond traditional summer beach tourism into cultural heritage, desert and adventure travel, and wellness tourism, alongside strong regional demand from Algeria and Libya (which together accounted for well over 2.7 million visitors) and recovering European arrivals, led by France.

Sector Composition

- Beach and coastal tourism along the Mediterranean coastline the traditional core of the industry.
- Cultural and heritage tourism centred on Carthage, the medina of Tunis, El Jem's Roman amphitheatre, and other UNESCO World Heritage sites.
- Desert and adventure tourism in the Sahara-adjacent south, including the Ksour region and Star Wars filming locations near Tozeur a niche with direct relevance to the film-cooperation opportunity discussed in Chapter 8.
- Wellness tourism, leveraging Tunisia's established thalassotherapy (seawater spa) industry, among the most developed in the Mediterranean.

Indian Tourist Market

India's outbound leisure travel market is among the fastest-growing globally, but Indian arrivals to Tunisia remain a small fraction of overall visitor numbers, which are dominated by European and neighbouring Maghreb markets. This represents a largely untapped opportunity: Tunisia currently has limited visibility among Indian outbound travel agents and tour operators relative to established Indian outbound destinations in Europe, the Gulf and Southeast Asia.

Tunisia's Strength

A diversified, record-breaking tourism product spanning beach, cultural, desert and wellness segments; demonstrated ability to extend seasonality and attract higher-spending visitor segments; and a strategic ambition, articulated by Tunisia's Ministry of Tourism, to become a top-three African tourism destination alongside Morocco and Egypt.

Tunisia's Challenge

Heavy dependence on European and neighbouring-Maghreb source markets, with limited diversification into high-growth outbound markets such as India; direct air connectivity between India and Tunisia remains limited, which materially constrains growth in Indian arrivals. This connectivity gap is compounded by low brand visibility for Tunisia within India's outbound travel trade, where the destination remains under-marketed relative to competing Mediterranean and North African offerings. This report treats improved connectivity as a downstream outcome of demonstrated commercial demand, not as an existing fact, consistent with the sequencing set out below.

Analytical Sequence: Promotion → Flows → Viability → Connectivity

CCI India's proposed approach follows a deliberate sequence: sustained destination promotion to Indian travel trade and consumers, leading to measurable growth in Indian tourist flows to Tunisia, which in turn builds the commercial case for greater direct or one-stop air connectivity rather than assuming connectivity improvements will precede demand. This sequencing avoids overstating current market readiness while identifying a credible, demand-led pathway to stronger air links over time.

INDIA–TUNISIA TOURISM PROMOTION PROGRAMME

- Engage Indian travel agencies and tour operators specialising in Mediterranean, Europe-adjacent and multi-destination itineraries to evaluate Tunisia as an add-on or standalone package destination.
- Participate in and organise presence at major Indian travel trade fairs to profile Tunisia's diversified tourism product to the Indian trade.
- Facilitate destination-familiarisation visits (fam trips) for Indian tour operators and travel media.
- Connect Tunisian hotel groups and destination management companies with Indian hospitality and MICE (meetings, incentives, conferences, exhibitions) buyers.
- Support targeted media and digital-content campaigns aimed at Indian outbound travellers, in coordination with Tunisia's National Tourist Office (ONTT).
- Engage airline stakeholders on the commercial case for improved India-Tunisia connectivity once demonstrable demand signals are established.

Expected Outcome

Measurable growth in Indian arrivals to Tunisia over a three-year horizon, the inclusion of Tunisia in mainstream Indian outbound tour-operator catalogues, and a credible, data-supported case for enhanced air connectivity.

CHAPTER 8 FILM & ENTERTAINMENT

Tunisia as a Production Destination

Tunisia has hosted international film and television productions for decades, drawing on Mediterranean coastal scenery, Saharan desert landscapes around Tozeur and Douz, and extensive Carthaginian, Roman and Ottoman-era heritage architecture. The country's most globally recognised association is with the Star Wars film franchise, portions of which were filmed in and around Tozeur and Matmata beginning in the late 1970s, alongside numerous other international European and American productions over subsequent decades. Tunisia maintains a functioning local production-services ecosystem location scouting, crew, equipment rental and post-production support oriented historically toward European (particularly French and Italian) producers, alongside a domestic film industry recognised regionally through festivals such as the Carthage Film Festival, one of the oldest film festivals in Africa and the Arab world.

Tunisia's Strength

- Visually distinctive, varied locations (Mediterranean coast, desert, Roman ruins, medina architecture) within a compact geographic area, reducing production logistics complexity relative to larger countries.
- An established, internationally experienced local production-services industry from decades of hosting foreign productions.
- Direct linkage to tourism: location-based film tourism (Star Wars-linked sites near Tozeur) already draws visitors independently of the tourism programme.

Tunisia's Challenge

Limited recent engagement with the Indian film industry specifically, despite decades of European and American production activity; and unless independently verified through direct engagement with Tunisian authorities the specific current structure of any government film-production incentives could not be corroborated from public sources reviewed for this report and should be confirmed directly with Tunisia's National Centre for Cinema and Image (CNCI) before any commercial commitment is made by Indian producers.

India Opportunity

India's film industry, led by Mumbai-based Hindi-language ('Bollywood') production but including major regional-language industries, is among the largest producers of feature films globally and has an established pattern of international location shooting across Europe, the Gulf, and other regions to access distinctive scenery, tax-efficient production environments, and lower crew costs. Tunisia is presently underexplored by Indian producers relative to more heavily marketed European and Gulf alternatives, despite offering comparable Mediterranean and desert visual variety within a single country.

Tunisia Opportunity in India

Beyond attracting Indian productions to Tunisia, there is a reciprocal opportunity for Tunisian and broader Maghreb cultural content, filmmakers and the Carthage Film Festival to build visibility and co-production relationships within India's film ecosystem and festival circuit, supporting people-to-people cultural exchange consistent with the existing 2023–2026 India-Tunisia Cultural Agreement covering theatre, dance, music, exhibitions and festivals.

Film Production → Local Spending → Hospitality → Transport → Services → Tourism

International film productions generate substantial local economic activity beyond the direct production budget: hotel and accommodation spending for cast and crew over multi-week shoots, ground transport and logistics contracts, catering, local crew and services employment, and critically destination marketing value when a production's setting becomes publicly associated with the filming location, as occurred with Tozeur following Star Wars.

This multiplier effect is the underlying economic rationale for CCI India's proposed film-cooperation initiative, connecting Chapter 7's tourism programme with a parallel film-sector engagement.

INDIA–TUNISIA FILM COOPERATION INITIATIVE

- Establish direct contact between CCI India, Tunisia's National Centre for Cinema and Image (CNCI) or equivalent film commission body, and major Indian production houses and location scouts to profile Tunisia's production ecosystem and (subject to verification) any applicable incentive framework.
- Organise familiarisation visits for Indian location scouts, line producers and directors to relevant Tunisian filming locations.
- Connect Tunisian production-services companies (crew, equipment, logistics) with Indian production houses planning international shoots.
- Support co-production and cultural-exchange dialogue between the Carthage Film Festival and Indian film festivals/institutions, building on the existing bilateral Cultural Agreement.
- Position location-based film tourism (existing and future) as a complementary strand of the broader tourism-promotion programme in Chapter 7.

Expected Outcome

At least one Indian production engagement (feature film, web series, or commercial) using Tunisian locations within a three-year horizon, and an established, ongoing relationship between CCI India, Tunisian film-sector institutions and the Indian production community.

CHAPTER 9 INDIA–TUNISIA BILATERAL RELATIONS

India and Tunisia established diplomatic relations in 1958, and the Embassy of India in Tunis describes the ensuing six and a half decades as marked by warm and cordial ties, encompassing trade, culture, people-to-people connections and tourism, sustained through high-level visits and structured institutional engagement. The two countries maintain a Joint Commission Meeting (JCM) mechanism the 12th session, held in New Delhi in October 2017, set the bilateral trade target of USD 1 billion within five years, a target that, as documented in Chapter 10, remains unmet and a Foreign Office Consultations (FOC) mechanism, the fifth round of which was held in Tunis on 17 May 2023, at which both sides reviewed trade and investment ties and the development partnership.

Development Cooperation

India's development cooperation with Tunisia includes Quick Impact Projects (QIPs) and capacity-building support under India's ITEC (Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation) programme, which offers Tunisian government officials and professionals training slots across Indian institutions.

The Embassy of India references an active QIP portfolio, including infrastructure projects such as a mini synthetic football ground under construction in Raoued Municipality, Ariana, intended to strengthen community sports infrastructure and people-to-people goodwill at the grassroots level.

Cultural Cooperation

India and Tunisia signed a three-year Cultural Agreement (2023–2026) covering theatre, dance, music, exhibitions, archaeology, museums, literature and festivals. Since 2014, cultural engagement has included ICCR-sponsored music, dance and theatre performances, yoga programming, exhibitions, and Indian film-festival participation. Notable milestones include the 2018 Festival of India in Tunisia, the establishment of a Gandhi Udyan (Gandhi Garden) in Tunis in 2019, continuous Tunisian participation in India's Surajkund Crafts Mela since 2016, and the 2024 formation of the Tunisia-India Friendship Association, which supports ongoing educational, artistic and wellness exchange.

Multilateral and Technology Cooperation

Beyond the bilateral track, India and Tunisia engage multilaterally at the United Nations and other fora. Cooperation themes referenced in recent bilateral dialogue and consistent with both countries' stated priorities include agriculture, water management, renewable energy, and digital public infrastructure an emerging cluster of technology-cooperation themes sometimes grouped under a broader 'Trade, Technology and Training' framing that aligns closely with India's global development-partnership approach and with CCI India's proposed capacity-building pillar (Chapter 14, Pillar 11).

Implication for CCI India

The diplomatic and cultural relationship is mature, active and well-institutionalised. What this chapter's review makes clear is that the business-to-business layer structured trade delegations, sector working groups, systematic market intelligence, and an investment pipeline has not kept pace with the strength of the political relationship. This gap is precisely where CCI India's proposed framework, developed in Chapter 14 onward, is intended to add value.

CHAPTER 10 INDIA–TUNISIA TRADE RELATIONS

Aggregate Bilateral Trade

According to the Embassy of India in Tunis, bilateral trade reached US\$521.71 million in 2024–25, and stood at US\$449.56 million for the period April 2025–January 2026, comprising Indian exports of US\$316.76 million and imports from Tunisia of US\$132.80 million.

Independently, UN COMTRADE-sourced data (via Trading Economics) records Indian exports to Tunisia at US\$356.87 million and Indian imports from Tunisia at US\$167.50 million for calendar year 2024, figures broadly consistent with, though not identical to, the Embassy's fiscal-year figures the difference reflecting different reporting periods (Indian fiscal year April–March versus calendar year) and standard cross-database variance. Both sources confirm the same structural picture: India runs a substantial and persistent trade surplus with Tunisia, and total bilateral trade remains well short of the USD 1 billion target set by the two governments in 2017.

Metric	Value	Period	Source
Total bilateral trade	US\$521.71 million	2024–25 (Indian FY)	Embassy of India, Tunis
Indian exports to Tunisia	US\$316.76 million	Apr 2025–Jan 2026	Embassy of India, Tunis
Indian imports from Tunisia	US\$132.80 million	Apr 2025–Jan 2026	Embassy of India, Tunis
Indian exports to Tunisia (COMTRADE)	US\$356.87 million	CY 2024	UN COMTRADE via Trading Economics
Indian imports from Tunisia (COMTRADE)	US\$167.50 million	CY 2024	UN COMTRADE via Trading Economics
2017 bilateral trade target	US\$1,000 million (not yet achieved)	Set 2017, 5-yr horizon	12th India-Tunisia JCM, New Delhi

Composition of Trade

Tunisia's exports to India are heavily concentrated in inorganic chemicals principally phosphoric acid under the TIFERT arrangement which accounted for US\$117.16–119.57 million of Tunisia's roughly US\$150–168 million in exports to India in 2024 across the two data sources, representing 70–78% of the total. This is followed at much smaller scale by edible fruits and nuts (including dates), textile articles, electrical/electronic equipment, animal and vegetable fats and oils (including olive oil), and aluminium. India's exports to Tunisia, per the Embassy of India, include automobiles, electrical equipment, machinery, cotton, rice, coffee, tea, spices, sugar and pharmaceutical products, reflecting a diversified industrial and agricultural export basket.

Tunisia's Top Exports to India (COMTRADE, CY2024)	Value
Inorganic chemicals, precious metal compounds, isotopes (incl. phosphoric acid)	US\$117.16 million
Other made textile articles, sets, worn clothing	US\$8.46 million
Edible fruits, nuts, peel of citrus fruit, melons (incl. dates)	US\$8.14 million
Electrical, electronic equipment	US\$3.57 million
Animal, vegetable fats and oils, cleavage products (incl. olive oil)	US\$2.63 million
Aluminium	US\$2.27 million

Products with Potential for Increased Indian Exports to Tunisia

- Generic pharmaceuticals India's global leadership in generic drug manufacturing is underleveraged in a Tunisian market that imports substantial pharmaceutical volumes; a dedicated CCI India pharma trade mission could accelerate registration and distribution partnerships.
- Agricultural commodities (rice, sugar, tea, spices) already present in the trade basket, with room for volume growth via more structured distributor relationships.
- Automotive and auto components India's cost-competitive vehicle and component manufacturing is well suited to a price-sensitive North African market, building on existing automobile exports referenced by the Embassy of India.
- Textile machinery and technical textiles complementary to Tunisia's own textile export industry (Chapter 3), supplying inputs rather than competing finished-goods.
- Renewable-energy equipment and EPC services aligned with Tunisia's energy-transition priorities (Chapter 3) and existing bilateral cooperation dialogue on renewable energy.

Products with Potential for Increased Tunisian Exports to India

- Bottled, premium olive oil currently a minor trade line (US\$1.28–2.63 million) against a global export base of hundreds of thousands of tonnes; the single largest untapped opportunity identified in this report (see Chapter 4).
- Premium Deglet Nour dates similarly a minor current trade line relative to Tunisia's global date-export leadership (see Chapter 5).
- Expanded phosphoric acid and downstream fertilizer products building on the proven TIFERT relationship, with room for capacity expansion (see Chapter 6).
- Processed agri-food products (date paste/syrup, olive-based cosmetics) value-added extensions of Tunisia's existing raw commodity strengths.

Trade Trend and Concentration

The available multi-year data indicates that bilateral trade has been broadly stable rather than steadily growing, with India's exports consistently several multiples larger than its imports from Tunisia. This asymmetry, combined with the near-total concentration of Tunisia's exports to India in a single chemical product line (phosphoric acid), represents both a vulnerability, since Tunisia's trade with India is exposed to a single sector, and an opportunity, since diversification into olive oil, dates and processed foods would broaden and strengthen the relationship for both sides. A more balanced and diversified export base would also make Tunisia's trade position with India less sensitive to global phosphate price cycles, which have historically driven sharp swings in the bilateral trade figures. Addressing this concentration is therefore not merely a matter of commercial upside but a structural priority for building a more resilient bilateral trade relationship.

CHAPTER 11 INVESTMENT & JOINT VENTURES

Tunisia's Investment Environment

Foreign investment in Tunisia is coordinated principally through FIPA-Tunisia (the Foreign Investment Promotion Agency), a public institution established in 1995 under the Ministry of Development, Investment and International Cooperation, which is ISO 9001-certified and maintains an international office network to support foreign investors through information services, investor matchmaking, and post-investment facilitation. Net FDI inflows into Tunisia were estimated at 1.6% of GDP in 2025, up from 1.4% in 2024, according to the World Bank a modest but improving trajectory that nonetheless remains well below Tunisia's stated ambitions and below the levels needed to durably close the country's financing gap. Tunisia offers various incentive frameworks for export-oriented and priority-sector investment, and its industrial zones and free-trade-adjacent manufacturing base have attracted European investors, including, in one recent example, a German electronics-manufacturing group's acquisition of a Swiss-owned production site in Tunisia.

Investment Barriers and Business Risks

- Currency controls on the non-convertible Tunisian dinar, requiring careful structuring of capital repatriation.
- Elevated domestic borrowing costs and constrained local financing, per the World Bank's assessment of tight domestic liquidity.
- Administrative complexity in certain regulatory approval processes, a commonly cited constraint across North African investment climates generally, though Tunisia's FIPA structure is specifically designed to mitigate this for foreign investors.
- Periodic social and political volatility, including labour actions affecting phosphate-sector output (Chapter 6), which investors should factor into supply-chain and operational risk planning.

Priority Sectors for India–Tunisia Joint Ventures

Sector	JV Rationale
Fertilizers & Chemicals	Builds directly on the proven TIFERT model; capacity expansion and downstream specialty chemicals.
Agriculture & Food Processing	Value-added processing of olive oil and dates for export to India and re-export to Africa/EU.
Olive Oil	Upstream cultivation cooperation and downstream bottling/branding partnerships targeting the Indian market.
Dates	Processing (paste, syrup) and branded packaging joint ventures targeting Indian gifting and food-manufacturing demand.
Pharmaceuticals	Contract manufacturing and technology transfer leveraging India's generics expertise and Tunisia's EU/Africa market access.

Auto Components	Contract manufacturing using Tunisia's EU-preferential access as an export platform for Indian component makers.
Renewable Energy	EPC and equipment-supply partnerships aligned with Tunisia's solar, wind and green-hydrogen ambitions.
ICT / Digital Public Infrastructure	Technical-assistance and technology-partnership models drawing on India's digital-identity and payments expertise.
Tourism & Hospitality	Hotel management, destination-marketing and MICE-sector partnerships.
Film & Entertainment	Co-production and production-services partnerships (see Chapter 8).

CCI India's Role

CCI India can serve as an investment-facilitation intermediary between Indian investors and FIPA-Tunisia, helping to identify credible Tunisian JV partners, structure introductory investor missions, and connect Indian financing institutions with viable Tunisian project pipelines a role distinct from, and complementary to, both governments' own investment-promotion machinery.

CHAPTER 12 MAJOR CHALLENGES FACING TUNISIA

This chapter analyses Tunisia's principal structural challenges using a consistent chain: Challenge → Impact → Business Implication → India Opportunity → CCI India Response.

Economic Challenges

Growth remains modest 2.5% in 2025, forecast at 2.1% in 2026 before recovering to 2.8% in 2027 reflecting weak private investment, labour-market rigidity and limited productivity gains, per the African Development Bank's 2026 Tunisia Economic Outlook. Impact: a domestic market that will not, on its own, generate rapid organic demand growth for imported goods in the near term. Business implication: Indian exporters should prioritise sectors with structural, non-discretionary demand. India opportunity: precisely the agri-input, pharmaceutical and industrial-input categories already identified in Chapter 10. CCI India response: sustain trade-facilitation efforts through the growth cycle rather than treating near-term softness as a reason to defer engagement, since first-mover market position compounds over a multi-year horizon.

Employment Challenges

Youth unemployment stood at 38.4% in 2025, alongside unemployment of 22.4% among women and 24.9% among college graduates, reflecting a persistent skills-to-opportunity mismatch. Impact: social pressure and a large pool of educated, underemployed talent. Business implication: a genuine opportunity for labour-intensive, export-oriented Indian investment (manufacturing, IT-enabled services) to access skilled talent at competitive cost. India opportunity: joint ventures explicitly structured around job creation strengthen both commercial and diplomatic positioning.

CCI India response: position job-creating investment proposals prominently in engagement with Tunisian government counterparts, given the direct alignment with a stated national priority.

Business Environment Challenges

Financing constraints and elevated domestic borrowing costs, alongside administrative complexity in some regulatory processes, continue to limit private investment, per World Bank assessments. Business implication: Indian investors should budget realistic timelines for regulatory approval and plan financing structures that minimise reliance on local Tunisian debt. India opportunity: Indian investors bringing their own capital (rather than relying on local financing) face a comparatively lower barrier than domestic Tunisian firms. CCI India response: maintain an up-to-date practical guide to Tunisia's investment-approval process for Indian investors, developed in partnership with FIPA-Tunisia.

Trade Challenges

Tunisia's trade deficit widened in recent years (imports of US\$26.4 billion against exports of US\$23.3 billion in 2024), and its export base remains concentrated by both product (textiles, mechanical/electrical goods, phosphates, agri-food) and market (the EU absorbs roughly 70% of goods exports). Business implication: Tunisia has a clear strategic and commercial incentive to diversify toward markets such as India. India opportunity: this report's central recommendation expanded olive oil, date and processed-food trade with India directly addresses this Tunisian diversification imperative. CCI India response: frame all market-access advocacy explicitly in terms of Tunisia's own diversification interest, strengthening the case for cooperation with Tunisian government counterparts.

Environmental and Water Challenges

Tunisia faces significant water scarcity, a constraint directly relevant to both its olive and date sectors (Chapters 4–5) and referenced explicitly as a theme in bilateral cooperation dialogue on water management. Impact: long-term production risk for Tunisia's flagship agricultural exports. Business implication: Indian buyers and investors in agri-food should factor water-related supply risk into long-term sourcing and investment decisions. India opportunity: India's water-management and irrigation-technology expertise (drip irrigation, water-efficient agriculture) is directly applicable. CCI India response: incorporate water-technology cooperation as an explicit strand of the agriculture and food-processing working group proposed in Chapter 14.

Energy Challenges

Tunisia remains a net energy importer pursuing an ambitious renewable-energy transition, including solar, wind and green-hydrogen ambitions (Chapter 3). Business implication and India opportunity: as detailed in Chapter 3, this is a direct opening for Indian renewable-energy EPC contractors and equipment suppliers. CCI India response: include energy-transition partnerships within the investment and JV working group.

CHAPTER 13 INDIA–TUNISIA TRADE & INVESTMENT GAPS

The following framework consolidates the sector-by-sector analysis of Chapters 3–12 into a single view of where current India-Tunisia engagement stands, where the largest untapped opportunity lies, what specifically blocks fuller engagement, and where CCI India can add the greatest incremental value.

Sector	Current Engagement	Untapped Opportunity	Key Barrier	CCI Intervention	Priority
Fertilizers/Chemicals	Strong (TIFERT, ~50% of Tunisia's phosphoric acid exports)	Capacity expansion, new JVs	Financing, feedstock reliability	Partnership Forum (Ch. 14)	High
Olive Oil	Minimal (~US\$1–3m of trade)	Very large Tunisia is a top-2 global exporter	No Indian importer network, tariffs, branding	Market Development Programme	High
Dates	Minimal (~US\$8m of trade)	Large premium gifting/festive market	Fragmented exporters, market access	Dates Market Access Programme	High
Tourism	Minimal Indian arrivals	Large 11m total visitors in 2025	Limited air connectivity, low trade awareness	Tourism Promotion Programme	Medium
Investment/JVs (general)	Limited beyond TIFERT	Broad, across pharma, auto components, renewables	Financing constraints, awareness gap	Investment & JV Forum	Medium
Film & Entertainment	Historic (Star Wars) but not India-linked	Location shoots, co-production	Limited India-specific outreach	Film Cooperation Initiative	Medium
Pharmaceuticals	Minimal	Generics manufacturing, distribution	Registration processes, awareness	Working group scoping mission	Medium
Renewable Energy	Minimal	EPC, solar/wind/hydrogen equipment	Financing, project pipeline visibility	Energy strand within JV Forum	Emerging
ICT/Digital Public Infrastructure	Nascent, dialogue-stage	Technical assistance, DPI partnerships	Requires government-to-government track	Support Trade/Tech/Trading track	Emerging

Where CCI India Can Create the Greatest Additional Value

The matrix above indicates that CCI India's highest-value near-term role lies in the agri-food sectors olive oil and dates where Tunisia possesses undisputed global-scale production strength, India possesses clear and growing consumer demand, and yet current bilateral trade is negligible relative to the scale of the underlying opportunity. These two sectors require primarily market-development and trade-facilitation work CCI India's core competency rather than large capital mobilisation, making them the fastest-to-execute, highest-return priorities. Fertilizers and chemicals represent the deepest, most proven relationship and merit sustained stewardship and expansion rather than new market-entry effort. Tourism, investment/JVs, film and the emerging technology-cooperation themes represent medium-to-longer-horizon opportunities requiring sustained institutional effort.

CHAPTER 14 HOW CCI INDIA CAN CONTRIBUTE

This is the most important chapter of the report. It develops a comprehensive CCI India–Tunisia Economic Cooperation Framework, structured around eleven pillars. Throughout, CCI India is positioned as a trade facilitator, business connector, investment facilitator, policy-advocacy platform, knowledge and market-intelligence provider, government–industry bridge, partnership facilitator and sectoral ecosystem builder never as a government regulator, and never displacing the roles of the Embassy of Tunisia in New Delhi, the Embassy of India in Tunis, or the two governments' own trade and investment bodies.

PILLAR 1 TRADE FACILITATION

- Connect Indian exporters/importers with verified Tunisian counterparts and vice versa, prioritising the high-opportunity sectors identified in Chapter 13 (olive oil, dates, fertilizers/chemicals).
- Identify and maintain a working database of Tunisian buyers for Indian exports (pharmaceuticals, automobiles, agricultural commodities) and Indian buyers for Tunisian exports (olive oil, dates, chemicals).
- Organise recurring buyer-seller meetings and structured trade delegations in both directions, timed where possible to coincide with relevant trade fairs and seasonal demand windows (e.g., dates ahead of Diwali).
- Provide market intelligence tariff schedules, regulatory requirements, competitive landscape through periodic sector opportunity briefs (Pillar 10).
- Support export readiness for Tunisian SMEs seeking to enter the Indian market, and for Indian SMEs seeking to enter Tunisia, including guidance on documentation, standards and logistics.

PILLAR 2 INVESTMENT FACILITATION

- Identify Indian investors with a credible interest in Tunisia's priority sectors (Chapter 11) and connect them with FIPA-Tunisia and relevant Tunisian project sponsors.

- Build and maintain an investment-opportunity pipeline spanning fertilizers/chemicals expansion, agri-processing, pharmaceuticals, renewable energy and tourism infrastructure.
- Facilitate structured investor visits and due-diligence support, connecting Indian investors with Tunisian legal, financial and regulatory advisors.
- Support joint-venture formation by convening potential Indian and Tunisian partners around specific, well-scoped project opportunities rather than generic sector interest.
- Connect Indian and Tunisian financing stakeholders banks, development finance institutions, and export-credit agencies on both sides to address the financing constraints identified in Chapter 12.
- Organise periodic India–Tunisia investment forums bringing together investors, project sponsors and financiers in a structured deal-sourcing environment.

PILLAR 3 POLICY ADVOCACY

CCI India can facilitate structured engagement between Indian industry and relevant government bodies on the specific market-access issues identified throughout this report without itself acting as a government body. Relevant Indian counterparts include the Ministry of External Affairs, the Department of Commerce, the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), and other relevant central ministries; relevant Tunisian counterparts include the appropriate ministries and Tunisia's Embassy in New Delhi. Priority advocacy themes, drawn directly from the barriers identified in this report, include:

- Tariff treatment for Tunisian olive oil entering the Indian market (Chapter 4).
- Market-access and phytosanitary clearance processes for Tunisian dates (Chapter 5).
- Investment-facilitation measures supporting fertilizer/chemicals sector expansion (Chapter 6).
- Trade-facilitation measures customs, documentation, logistics that would reduce friction in both directions.

PILLAR 4 SECTORAL WORKING GROUPS

CCI India should establish standing, sector-specific working groups to sustain engagement beyond one-off events. Each is proposed with a consistent structure:

India–Tunisia Olive Oil Working Group

- Objective: convert Tunisia's global olive-oil export leadership into a meaningful, growing share of India's olive-oil import basket.
- Stakeholders: Tunisian exporter associations, Indian edible-oil importers/distributors, Indian modern-trade and e-commerce buyers, hospitality-sector representatives.
- Structure: co-chaired by a CCI India representative and a nominated Tunisian industry representative; quarterly meetings.
- Activities: market intelligence updates, buyer-seller matchmaking, joint promotional planning.
- KPIs: growth in Tunisia's share of Indian olive-oil imports; number of active Tunisian-exporter/Indian-importer relationships established.

India–Tunisia Agriculture & Food Processing Working Group

- Objective: expand cooperation beyond olive oil and dates into broader agri-processing, food technology and water-efficient agriculture partnerships.
- Stakeholders: Indian food-processing companies, Tunisian agri-cooperatives and processors, agricultural technology providers.
- Structure: semi-annual meetings; working-level technical exchange on irrigation and processing technology.
- KPIs: number of joint pilot projects initiated; volume of processed agri-food trade.

India–Tunisia Fertilizer & Chemicals Working Group

- Objective: steward and expand the TIFERT relationship and explore adjacent chemical-sector cooperation.
- Stakeholders: TIFERT partners (Coromandel, GSFC, CPG, GCT), other Indian fertilizer majors, Tunisian chemical-sector bodies.
- Structure: annual forum aligned with existing industry review cycles.
- KPIs: phosphoric-acid offtake volumes; progress on any new capacity or JV proposals.

India–Tunisia Tourism & Hospitality Working Group

- Objective: grow Indian tourist arrivals to Tunisia and build the commercial case for improved air connectivity.
- Stakeholders: Indian tour operators/travel agencies, Tunisian hotel groups and ONTT, airline representatives.
- Structure: quarterly coordination calls, annual joint promotional planning session.
- KPIs: Indian arrivals to Tunisia year-on-year; number of Indian tour operators featuring Tunisia.

India–Tunisia Film & Entertainment Working Group

- Objective: secure at least one Indian production engagement with Tunisian locations and build a sustained co-production relationship.
- Stakeholders: Indian production houses, Tunisian film-services companies, CNCI or equivalent film commission body.
- Structure: project-based engagement supplemented by an annual review meeting.
- KPIs: number of Indian productions using Tunisian locations; co-production or festival-exchange activities completed.

India–Tunisia Investment & JV Working Group

- Objective: build and progress a live pipeline of India-Tunisia joint-venture and investment opportunities across priority sectors (Chapter 11).
- Stakeholders: Indian investors and industry bodies, FIPA-Tunisia, Tunisian project sponsors, financing institutions.
- Structure: quarterly pipeline-review meetings; ad hoc deal-specific working sessions.
- KPIs: number of investment leads generated; number progressing to due diligence or closing.

PILLAR 5 MARKET ACCESS INITIATIVE

CCI India should establish a standing CCI India–Tunisia Market Access Initiative combining market intelligence, tariff analysis, regulatory guidance, importer/distributor identification, buyer-seller matching, product-positioning support, and organised trade missions and business delegations functioning as the operational backbone supporting the sector-specific programmes.

PILLAR 6 OLIVE OIL PROGRAMME

Developed in full in Chapter 4 as the Tunisia–India Olive Oil Market Development Initiative, structured across six phases from market research through long-term market development, anchored by the standing Olive Oil Working Group described above.

PILLAR 7 DATES PROGRAMME

Developed in full in Chapter 5 as the Tunisia–India Dates Trade Initiative, with particular focus on the Diwali and corporate-gifting season, e-commerce channels, and food-processing ingredient supply.

PILLAR 8 TOURISM PROGRAMME

Developed in full in Chapter 7 as the Tunisia–India Tourism Corridor, engaging travel agencies, tour operators, hotels, tourism authorities, airlines, media and cultural organisations in a demand-led sequence toward improved destination visibility and, ultimately, connectivity.

PILLAR 9 FILM PROGRAMME

Developed in full in Chapter 8 as the India–Tunisia Film Cooperation Initiative, engaging Indian producers, directors, location scouts, Tunisian production companies and the CNCI/film-commission body, alongside cultural-exchange activity building on the existing bilateral Cultural Agreement.

PILLAR 10 KNOWLEDGE & RESEARCH

CCI India should establish a regular publication programme to sustain informed engagement, including a Tunisia Market Intelligence Report (updated periodically), an India–Tunisia Trade Opportunity Report, sector-specific knowledge papers on olive oil and dates, an Investment Opportunity Report, additional sector opportunity briefs as priorities evolve, a regulatory guide for Indian businesses entering the Tunisian market, and a maintained buyer/seller and business directory supporting the trade-facilitation work described in Pillar 1.

CHAPTER 15 PROPOSED INDIA–TUNISIA BUSINESS COUNCIL

A review of publicly available sources did not identify an existing, dedicated, formally constituted India–Tunisia Business Council comparable to bilateral business councils India maintains with a number of other partner countries; this absence itself should be independently confirmed with the Embassy of Tunisia and relevant Indian trade bodies before CCI India proceeds, consistent with this report's instruction not to assume information is current without verification. On the assumption that no such dedicated mechanism currently exists in an active form, this chapter assesses the feasibility of CCI India either establishing an India–Tunisia Business Council or, if an equivalent mechanism is found to already exist, positioning itself to complement and strengthen it.

Purpose

An India–Tunisia Business Council would provide the durable institutional home for the sectoral working groups proposed in Chapter 14, giving the bilateral business relationship a standing structure independent of any single event, delegation or individual relationship.

Proposed Governance and Structure

- Co-chaired structure, with CCI India (or a coalition of Indian chambers) as the Indian co-chair and a nominated Tunisian chamber or industry federation as the Tunisian co-chair.
- Membership open to Indian and Tunisian companies with an active or prospective interest in bilateral trade and investment, structured around annual membership.
- Sector committees mirroring the working groups proposed in Chapter 14 (olive oil, dates, fertilizers/chemicals, tourism, film, investment/JVs), each reporting into the Council's governing board.
- Government participation in an advisory, non-executive capacity relevant Indian ministries and the Government of Tunisia's economic ministries preserving the Council's identity as a private-sector-led body.
- Embassy participation, where appropriate, as an observer and facilitator, given the Embassy of Tunisia's and Embassy of India's existing convening roles.
- Private-sector participation from both countries as the Council's core constituency and primary source of legitimacy and activity.
- Meeting frequency: a full Council plenary at least annually, with sector-committee meetings on the quarterly-to-semi-annual cadence set out in Chapter 14.
- A structured B2B mechanism a standing directory and matchmaking function feeding directly from the Market Access Initiative described in Chapter 14, Pillar 5.
- An investment pipeline function, tracking live opportunities identified through the Investment & JV Working Group and reporting progress at each plenary.
- Monitoring: a simple, published set of KPIs (bilateral trade volume, number of active B2B relationships, investment deals progressed) reviewed at each plenary meeting.

If an Equivalent Mechanism Already Exists

Should verification confirm that an India–Tunisia Business Council or comparable mechanism already exists whether housed within another Indian chamber, an existing bilateral trade body, or a joint government-industry platform CCI India's recommended course is not duplication but complementary specialisation: positioning itself as the lead convenor for the specific priority sectors developed in this report (olive oil, dates, fertilizers/chemicals, tourism, film), while channelling broader institutional and government-facing functions through the existing mechanism.

CHAPTER 16 INDIAN STATE-LEVEL OPPORTUNITIES

Sector compatibility with Tunisia's priority industries points to a set of Indian states where State Government and state-level industry engagement could meaningfully reinforce the national-level programme developed in this report.

Gujarat

Why this State: Gujarat is home to Gujarat State Fertilizers and Chemicals Limited (GSFC), one of the two Indian partners in the TIFERT joint venture, and hosts a substantial chemicals and petrochemicals manufacturing cluster.

Why Tunisia: Tunisia's phosphate and chemical-processing base is the most proven point of India-Tunisia industrial partnership. Sector: fertilizers, chemicals, and potentially pharmaceuticals given Gujarat's pharmaceutical manufacturing strength.

Opportunity: expansion of the existing GSFC-TIFERT relationship and exploration of new chemicals or pharma joint ventures.

CCI Role: convene Gujarat-based chemical and pharma companies alongside the Fertilizer & Chemicals Working Group (Chapter 14).

Andhra Pradesh

Why this State: home to Coromandel International's Kakinada facility, the receiving point for TIFERT's phosphoric-acid offtake, and a significant agri-processing and port-logistics base.

Why Tunisia: direct existing supply-chain linkage through TIFERT. Sector: fertilizers, port logistics, agri-processing.

Opportunity: deepen the existing offtake relationship and explore port-to-port logistics cooperation given both Kakinada's and Skhira's roles in the trade.

CCI Role: include Andhra Pradesh port and logistics stakeholders in fertilizer working-group discussions on supply-chain resilience.

Maharashtra

Why this State: Mumbai's role as India's commercial and film-production capital, and Maharashtra's broader strength in food processing, pharmaceuticals and financial services.

Why Tunisia: direct relevance to both the Film Cooperation Initiative and pharmaceutical/food-processing opportunities. Sector: film & entertainment, pharmaceuticals, food processing, financial/investment services.

Opportunity: connect Mumbai-based production houses to the Film Working Group, and Maharashtra-based pharma and food companies to relevant working groups.

CCI Role: use Mumbai as a natural hub for film-industry outreach activities under Pillar 9.

Delhi-NCR

Why this State: seat of the Embassy of Tunisia, CCI India's own headquarters, and India's principal diplomatic and policy-advocacy hub.

Why Tunisia: the natural venue for high-level bilateral engagement, the Business Council, and policy-advocacy activity (Pillar 3).

Sector: cross-cutting policy, investment facilitation, trade-mission coordination. Opportunity: institutional home for the proposed Business Council and Working Groups.

CCI Role: central coordinating hub for the entire framework set out in this report.

Rajasthan

Why this State: significant dry-fruit trading and gems/handicraft export tradition, alongside a growing food-processing sector.

Why Tunisia: natural fit with the Dates Trade Initiative given Rajasthan's established dry-fruit trading networks. Sector: dates and dry-fruit trade.

Opportunity: connect Rajasthan-based dry-fruit importers/distributors to Tunisian date exporters.

CCI Role: include Rajasthan trade bodies in the Dates Working Group's importer-identification work.

Karnataka

Why this State: Bengaluru's strength in ICT and digital-services, alongside a growing renewable-energy manufacturing base.

Why Tunisia: relevance to the ICT/digital-public-infrastructure cooperation theme and renewable-energy opportunity.

Sector: ICT, digital public infrastructure, renewable energy. Opportunity: technical-assistance and technology-partnership models.

CCI Role: connect Karnataka-based technology and renewable-energy firms to the relevant emerging-opportunity strands identified in Chapter 13.

TUNISIA–INDIAN STATE PARTNERSHIP MODEL

CCI India should formalise state-level engagement not as a parallel structure but as a feeder mechanism into the national sectoral working groups: each priority state above is mapped to the specific working group(s) most relevant to its industrial base, with CCI India's state-level chapters or partner industry bodies responsible for identifying and referring interested companies into the corresponding national working group.

CHAPTER 17 FLAGSHIP CCI INDIA INITIATIVES

1. India–Tunisia Business Council

Objective: Establish a standing bilateral business institution.

Problem addressed: Absence of a durable institutional home for bilateral B2B engagement.

CCI role: Co-convene and provide secretariat support. Government role: Advisory, non-executive participation. Private-sector role: Core membership and governance.

Relevant stakeholders: CCI India, Tunisian chamber counterpart, Embassy of Tunisia, Embassy of India, member companies.

Timeline: 0–6 months to establish; ongoing thereafter.

Expected outcome: A functioning, membership-based Council with active sector committees.

KPIs: Membership count; number of active sector committees; annual plenary attendance.

Risks and mitigation: Risk of duplication with an existing but inactive mechanism. Mitigation: Verify existing mechanisms first (Chapter 15) before formal launch.

2. Tunisia–India Olive Oil Market Access Programme

Objective: Grow Tunisia's share of India's olive-oil import market.

Problem addressed: Negligible current trade (~US\$1–3 million) against Tunisia's top-2 global export position.

CCI role: Market research, importer identification, buyer-seller meetings, promotional support. Government role: Tariff and market-access dialogue via Department of Commerce/DGFT. Private-sector role: Tunisian exporter associations; Indian importers, retailers, hospitality buyers.

Relevant stakeholders: 0–3 months: market research; 3–12 months: importer matchmaking and promotion; ongoing thereafter.

Timeline: Established Tunisian olive-oil presence in premium Indian retail and HORECA channels.

Expected outcome: Growth in import volume/value; number of active importer relationships.

KPIs: Price volatility from Tunisia's alternating harvest cycle.

Risks and mitigation: Structure multi-year supply agreements that smooth year-to-year variability. Mitigation: undefined

3. Tunisia–India Dates Trade Initiative

Objective: Build a repeatable seasonal trade pipeline for premium Deglet Nour dates into India's festive-gifting market.

Problem addressed: Minor current trade relative to Tunisia's global date-export leadership.

CCI role: Importer identification, buyer-seller meetings timed to Diwali season, product positioning. Government role: Phytosanitary/market-access facilitation as needed. Private-sector role: Tunisian date cooperatives/exporters; Indian dry-fruit distributors, corporate-gifting platforms.

Relevant stakeholders: Annual cycle, building from an initial pilot season.

Timeline: A recognised premium Tunisian date presence in India's gifting and gourmet segments.

Expected outcome: Trade volume growth; number of repeat-buyer relationships.

KPIs: Fragmented Tunisian exporter base complicating consistent quality/supply.

Risks and mitigation: Work with established cooperatives/PGI-certified exporters for initial pilot partnerships. Mitigation: undefined

4. India–Tunisia Fertilizer & Chemicals Partnership Forum

Objective: Steward and expand the proven TIFERT relationship.

Problem addressed: Feedstock and financing constraints limiting expansion despite a successful operating track record.

CCI role: Convene forum; facilitate technology-transfer and offtake discussions. Government role: Support via existing JCM/FOC mechanisms. Private-sector role: TIFERT partners; other Indian fertilizer majors; CPG/GCT.

Relevant stakeholders: Annual forum; ongoing working-group activity.

Timeline: Expanded or new India-Tunisia phosphate/chemicals capacity.

Expected outcome: Offtake volumes; number of new investment proposals advanced.

KPIs: Periodic phosphate-mining disruption from social/labour unrest.

Risks and mitigation: Encourage diversified, long-term contracted supply arrangements.
Mitigation: undefined

5. India–Tunisia Investment & JV Forum

Objective: Build a live cross-sector investment pipeline.

Problem addressed: Investment activity beyond TIFERT remains limited relative to Tunisia's sectoral potential.

CCI role: Investor identification, FIPA-Tunisia liaison, deal-sourcing forums. Government role: Facilitate via FIPA-Tunisia and Indian trade missions. Private-sector role: Indian investors/industry bodies; Tunisian project sponsors; financiers.

Relevant stakeholders: Quarterly pipeline reviews; annual investment forum.

Timeline: A growing pipeline of scoped, investable India-Tunisia JV opportunities.

Expected outcome: Number of leads generated and progressed to due diligence/closing.

KPIs: Financing constraints and currency-control complexity.

Risks and mitigation: Prioritise investors bringing independent capital; provide currency/repatriation guidance. Mitigation: undefined

6. Tunisia–India Tourism Promotion Programme

Objective: Grow Indian tourist arrivals to Tunisia.

Problem addressed: Minimal current Indian arrivals despite Tunisia's record 11 million total visitors in 2025.

CCI role: Trade-fair presence, fam trips, promotional campaigns. Government role: Coordinate with ONTT and relevant tourism authorities. Private-sector role: Indian tour operators/travel agencies; Tunisian hotels and DMCs.

Relevant stakeholders: 0–12 months: awareness building; 1–3 years: measurable arrivals growth.

Timeline: Tunisia established in mainstream Indian outbound tour-operator catalogues.

Expected outcome: Indian arrivals year-on-year; number of operators featuring Tunisia.

KPIs: Limited direct air connectivity constraining growth.

Risks and mitigation: Follow demand-led sequencing before advocating for new routes.
Mitigation: undefined

7. India–Tunisia Film & Entertainment Initiative

Objective: Secure Indian production engagement with Tunisian locations.

Problem addressed: Decades of foreign production activity in Tunisia with minimal India-specific engagement.

CCI role: Location-scout outreach, familiarisation visits, festival exchange. Government role: Liaise with CNCI/film-commission body. Private-sector role: Indian production houses; Tunisian production-services companies.

Relevant stakeholders: 0–12 months: outreach and fam visits; 1–3 years: first production engagement.

Timeline: At least one Indian production using Tunisian locations within three years.

Expected outcome: Number of productions/co-productions initiated.

KPIs: Unverified incentive framework may affect commercial viability.

Risks and mitigation: Confirm current incentive structure directly with CNCI before commercial commitments. Mitigation: undefined

8. India–Tunisia Food & Hospitality Exchange

Objective: Build culinary and hospitality-sector linkages supporting both the olive oil and tourism programmes.

Problem addressed: Limited current integration of Tunisian cuisine/ingredients into Indian hospitality channels.

CCI role: Chef exchanges, menu-integration partnerships, hospitality B2B matchmaking. Government role: Cultural-cooperation support under the 2023–2026 Cultural Agreement. Private-sector role: Indian hotel groups/restaurants; Tunisian culinary and hospitality bodies.

Relevant stakeholders: 1–2 years, building on the Olive Oil and Tourism programmes.

Timeline: Tunisian ingredients and culinary themes featured in Indian premium hospitality venues.

Expected outcome: Number of hospitality partnerships established.

KPIs: Niche appeal limiting scale.

Risks and mitigation: Anchor within existing premium/gourmet retail and tourism promotion activity rather than standalone effort. Mitigation: undefined

9. Tunisia–India State Government Partnership Programme

Objective: Translate Chapter 16's state-level mapping into active engagement.

Problem addressed: National-level cooperation not yet systematically connected to relevant Indian state industrial bases.

CCI role: Coordinate state-chamber outreach and referral into national working groups. Government role: State Government participation alongside central-government advisory roles. Private-sector role: State industry bodies; state-based companies in mapped sectors.

Relevant stakeholders: 1–2 years to establish active state-level linkages.

Timeline: Each priority state actively feeding relevant companies into national working groups.

Expected outcome: Number of state-referred companies engaged; state-level delegations organised.

KPIs: Coordination complexity across multiple state bodies.

Risks and mitigation: Use existing CCI India state presence and partner chambers as the coordination layer. Mitigation: undefined

10. India–Tunisia Trade, Technology & Training Initiative

Objective: Extend cooperation into digital public infrastructure, renewable energy technology and capacity building.

Problem addressed: Nascent, dialogue-stage cooperation on technology themes not yet translated into concrete projects.

CCI role: Convene technology-focused dialogue; coordinate with ITEC training programme. Government role: Government-to-government track leadership, given the technology-transfer and DPI dimensions. Private-sector role: Indian technology and renewable-energy companies; Tunisian government technical counterparts.

Relevant stakeholders: 1–3 years, following the government-to-government track's own pace.

Timeline: At least one concrete technology-cooperation project (DPI, renewable energy, or training) initiated.

Expected outcome: Number of technical-assistance engagements initiated.

KPIs: Requires sustained government-level coordination beyond CCI India's own remit.

Risks and mitigation: Position CCI India as a supporting convenor rather than lead on this government-led track. Mitigation: undefined

CHAPTER 18 IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

0–3 Months: Immediate Priorities

- Verify current institutional details (CCI India leadership, Embassy of Tunisia leadership, any existing India-Tunisia Business Council) directly with the relevant institutions.
- Commission the initial Indian olive-oil and dates market-intelligence studies (Chapters 4–5, Pillar 10).
- Establish initial contact with FIPA-Tunisia, Tunisia's ONTT, and the CNCI or equivalent film-commission body.
- Begin building the importer/distributor/investor databases underpinning the Market Access Initiative (Pillar 5).

3–6 Months: Short-Term Programmes

- Convene the first India–Tunisia Olive Oil and Dates buyer-seller meetings.
- Formally launch the sectoral working groups described in Chapter 14, Pillar 4, beginning with Olive Oil, Dates, and Fertilizers & Chemicals given their identified high-priority status.
- Initiate the first Tourism Working Group engagement with Indian tour operators and Tunisia's ONTT.

6–12 Months: Institutional Expansion

- Launch or formally engage with the India–Tunisia Business Council (Chapter 15), subject to the verification exercise in the 0–3 month phase.
- Extend working groups to Investment/JVs and Film & Entertainment.
- Begin state-level outreach under the Tunisia–Indian State Partnership Model (Chapter 16), starting with Gujarat, Andhra Pradesh and Maharashtra given their existing sectoral linkages.
- Publish the first Tunisia Market Intelligence Report and India–Tunisia Trade Opportunity Report.

1–3 Years: Long-Term Strategic Cooperation

- Progress at least one new investment or joint-venture proposal beyond TIFERT toward closing.
- Achieve measurable growth in Indian olive-oil and date imports from Tunisia, and in Indian tourist arrivals.
- Secure at least one Indian film/entertainment production engagement with Tunisian locations.
- Support progress toward closing the gap between current bilateral trade (~US\$521.71 million) and the USD 1 billion target set by the two governments in 2017.

CHAPTER 19 BUSINESS OPPORTUNITY MATRIX

1. Olive Oil — HIGH PRIORITY

- Tunisia's Strength: World's #2 olive oil exporter, accounting for approximately 27.9% of global exports in 2024–25.
- Indian Demand: Rising demand for Tunisian-origin olive oil in India.
- Opportunity: Premium bottled and branded olive oil.
- Business Model: Import and distribution through joint ventures, private labels and established distributors.
- CCI India Role: Market development programme; connect Tunisian producers with Indian importers, distributors and retailers.

2. Dates — HIGH PRIORITY

- Tunisia's Strength: Approximately 21% of global export value and around 2% of global export volume.
- Indian Demand: Large and growing demand for dates in India.
- Opportunity: Premium positioning of Tunisian dates.
- Business Model: Branded import partnerships and distribution.

- CCI India Role: Facilitate a dedicated Dates Trade Initiative connecting exporters with Indian buyers.

3. Fertilizers & Chemicals — HIGH PRIORITY

- Tunisia's Strength: World's #3 phosphate chemicals producer; proven joint-venture track record, including TIFERT.
- Indian Demand: Large and structurally growing demand for fertilizers and phosphate-based chemicals.
- Opportunity: Capacity expansion and development of new joint ventures.
- Business Model: Equity JVs, long-term offtake arrangements and strategic supply partnerships.
- CCI India Role: Facilitate a Partnership Forum between Tunisian producers, Indian fertilizer companies and potential investors.

4. Tourism — MEDIUM PRIORITY

- Tunisia's Strength: Record tourism performance, with approximately 11 million visitors in 2025 and a diversified tourism offering.
- Indian Demand: Fast-growing outbound tourism from India.
- Opportunity: Develop Tunisia as a new destination for Indian travellers.
- Business Model: Partnerships with Indian tour operators and travel companies.
- CCI India Role: Tourism promotion programmes, B2B meetings and destination-promotion initiatives.

5. Investment & Joint Ventures — MEDIUM PRIORITY

- Tunisia's Strength: Strong FIPA-backed investment framework and access to the European and African markets.
- Indian Demand: Growing interest among Indian companies in international investment and market expansion.
- Opportunity: Manufacturing and export-oriented investment through Tunisia.
- Business Model: Equity joint ventures and contract manufacturing.
- CCI India Role: Organise an Investment & JV Forum to connect Indian investors with Tunisian partners.

6. Film & Entertainment — MEDIUM PRIORITY

- Tunisia's Strength: Established international film-production ecosystem.
- Indian Demand: Large and expanding Indian entertainment and film industry.
- Opportunity: Location-based filming and co-production opportunities.
- Business Model: Production-service partnerships and co-production agreements.
- CCI India Role: Develop a Film Cooperation Initiative connecting Indian production houses with Tunisian stakeholders.

7. Pharmaceuticals — MEDIUM PRIORITY

- Tunisia's Strength: Growing generic pharmaceutical base with access to African and European markets.
- Indian Demand: World-leading Indian generic pharmaceutical industry.
- Opportunity: Technology transfer, pharmaceutical manufacturing and market expansion.
- Business Model: Licensing, technology partnerships and contract manufacturing JVs.
- CCI India Role: Scoping missions to identify pharmaceutical partnerships and manufacturing opportunities.

8. Renewable Energy — EMERGING

- Tunisia's Strength: Strong solar and wind resources with an ongoing energy-transition strategy.
- Indian Opportunity: Global Indian renewable-energy and EPC capabilities.

- Opportunity: Renewable-energy projects, equipment supply and infrastructure development.
- Business Model: EPC contracts, equipment supply and project-based partnerships.
- CCI India Role: Facilitate a JV Forum and connect Indian EPC companies, equipment manufacturers and Tunisian project developers.

9. ICT & Digital Public Infrastructure — EMERGING

- Tunisia's Strength: Nascent but growing digital infrastructure and technology ecosystem.
- Indian Opportunity: World-leading Indian digital public infrastructure and technology capabilities.
- Opportunity: Technical assistance, DPI deployment and digital-government solutions.
- Business Model: Government-to-government technology partnerships and MoUs.
- CCI India Role: Trade, Technology & Training Initiative; facilitate connections between Indian technology companies and Tunisian government institutions.

CHAPTER 20 STRATEGIC CONCLUSION

Why Tunisia Matters to India

Tunisia offers India a compact, strategically located, industrially proven partner at the crossroads of Europe, Africa and the Arab world a partner already validated through more than a decade of successful large-scale industrial cooperation in the TIFERT fertilizer joint venture, and one whose global leadership in olive oil and dates presents India with a rare opportunity to secure premium agri-food supply from an origin still largely absent from Indian retail shelves.

Why India Matters to Tunisia

For Tunisia, India represents a scale market and diversification opportunity precisely suited to its structural need to reduce dependence on a narrow set of European export destinations and a bulk-commodity trade model that has repeatedly compressed producer margins even in record-volume years. India's demonstrated appetite for phosphate-based fertilizer inputs, its rapidly growing premium food and gifting market, and its expanding outbound tourism and production industries each map directly onto specific, underexploited Tunisian strengths documented throughout this report.

Why CCI India Can Play a Strategic Role

The India-Tunisia diplomatic relationship is mature, warm and well-institutionalised, sustained through Joint Commission and Foreign Office Consultation mechanisms and an active cultural-cooperation agreement. What this report's analysis demonstrates is a persistent gap between that diplomatic warmth and the comparatively modest scale of bilateral trade (US\$521.71 million in 2024–25, against a 2017 target of USD 1 billion) and investment (limited largely to the single, if highly successful, TIFERT relationship).

CCI India, as a chamber whose core mission is business expansion, trade and investment facilitation, and policy advocacy, is positioned to close this gap functioning as a strategic facilitator, business connector, knowledge platform, investment enabler and policy bridge, and explicitly not as a government regulator or a substitute for either country's own trade and investment institutions.

Immediate Priorities

Verify institutional details; launch olive oil and dates market-intelligence work; establish first contact with FIPA-Tunisia, ONTT and the Tunisian film-commission body; and begin building the databases that will underpin every subsequent programme in this report.

One-Year Priorities

Operational sectoral working groups in the three high-priority areas (olive oil, dates, fertilizers/chemicals); a functioning or formally engaged Business Council; the first published market-intelligence reports; and initial state-level outreach in Gujarat, Andhra Pradesh and Maharashtra.

Three-Year Priorities

Measurable growth in bilateral trade toward the long-standing USD 1 billion target; at least one new investment or joint-venture proposal progressed beyond TIFERT; established Tunisian olive-oil and date brands in the Indian market; measurable growth in Indian tourist arrivals to Tunisia; and at least one Indian film or entertainment production using Tunisian locations.

TRADE → INVESTMENT → TECHNOLOGY → TOURISM → CULTURE → JOINT VENTURES

This sequence captures the natural progression this report recommends CCI India pursue: trade facilitation in high-priority agri-food and chemical sectors builds the commercial relationships and trust from which investment and joint-venture proposals naturally emerge; technology cooperation extends the relationship into renewable energy and digital infrastructure; tourism and culture broaden people-to-people engagement and public support for deeper economic ties; and the cycle reinforces itself as growing trade, investment, technology, tourism and cultural exchange each strengthen the case for the next.

THANK YOU

CCI India sincerely thanks Your Excellency for the warm hospitality and gracious interaction with our team. We greatly value the opportunity to discuss strengthening India-Tunisia bilateral trade and economic relations and look forward to deepening cooperation, expanding business engagement, and creating new avenues for trade, investment, and mutually beneficial partnerships between the two countries.



From Friendship to Partnership Advancing Shared Growth, Trade and Prosperity

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